



ICT Entry Models - ICT

International Finance (Utah Tech University)



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MASTER 5 ICT ENTRY MODELS

[Complete Guide →](#)

ICT 2022 Model

Core Framework

1st Presentation Model

Session Based Model

ICT Unicorn Model

Precision Model

ICT Inversion Model

Confirmation Model

ICT O.T.E Model

Retracement Model



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What's Inside This Thread

By the end of this, you'll know exactly which entry model to use, when, and why.

The list (5 Most Widely Used Models) :

- ICT 2022 Model
 - ICT Unicorn Model
 - ICT IFVG Model
 - ICT 1st PFVG Model
 - ICT Optimal Trade Entry Model
-

Important Note

Every ICT model performs best when aligned with higher timeframe order flow. Get your HTF bias right, and the model becomes significantly more effective. Get it wrong, and no model will save you. The model isn't the edge it's the tool you use after the narrative is built. Narrative first. Model second. Always in that order.

Risk management is non-negotiable, on every single trade. Trade responsibly.





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ICT 2022 Model

US 100 | M15 | ICT 2022 Model Representation

US 100 Cash CFD · 15 · FOREX.com O25,310.3 H25,346.4 L25,310.3 C25,328.3





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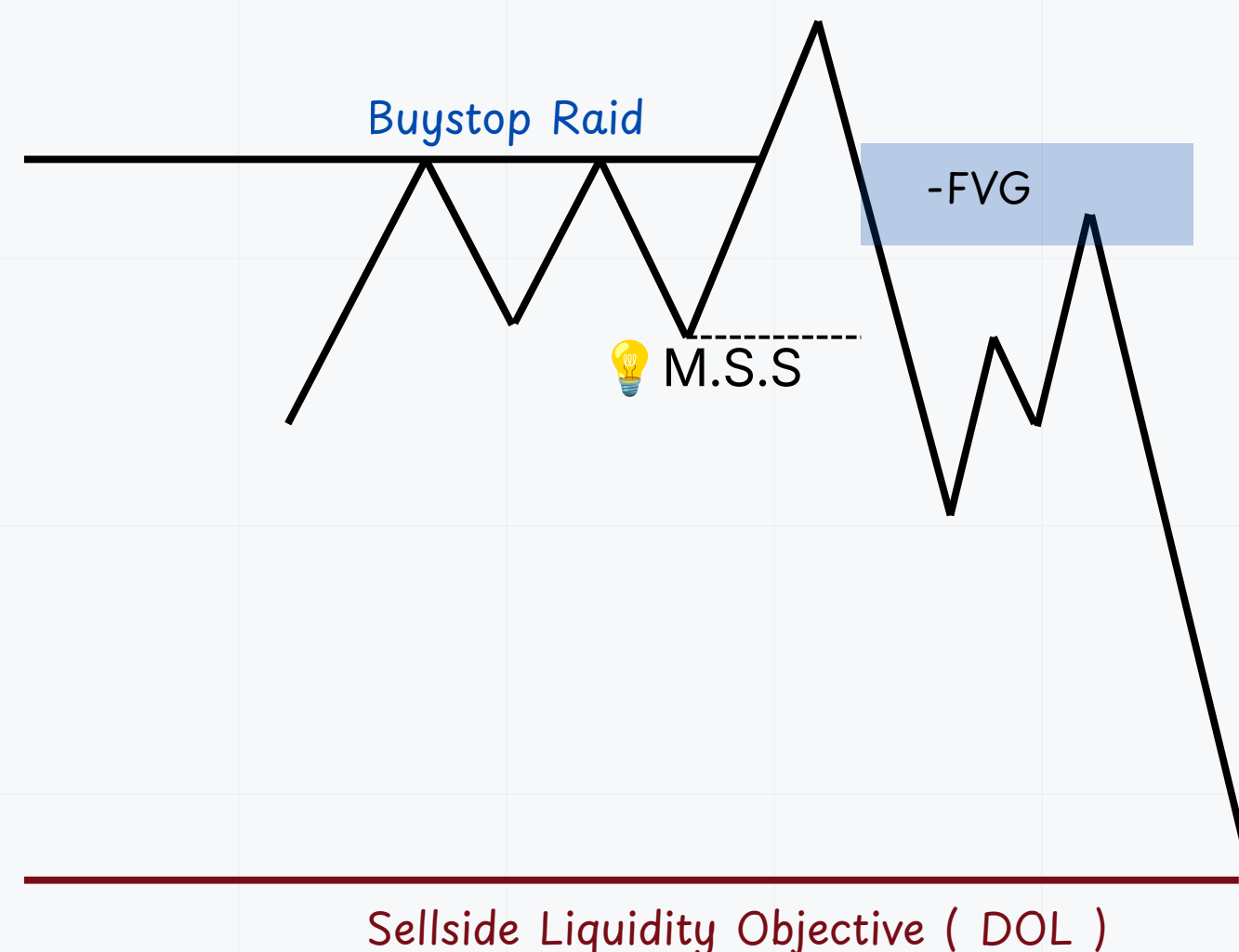
ICT 2022 Model

This Model is designed to do one thing :

Trade intraday market structure after liquidity is taken, using Fair Value Gaps, and target opposing PD arrays, at specific times of day with strict risk control

This is not a pattern system.

It's **liquidity** → **displacement** → **FVG** → **PD array targeting**, framed by time.



Step By Step Breakdown:

1. What this model is actually for

You are trying to :

- Sell in premium (when bearish)
- Buy in discount (when bullish)

And you only do that after:

1. Liquidity is raided
2. Market structure shifts
3. Price displaces
4. A Fair Value Gap forms

That sequence matters.

If that sequence is missing → no trade.

2. Sessions & Time Windows

Index Futures AM session

8:30 AM – 11:00 AM New York

PM session

Starts around 1:30 PM New York

That the algorithm prefers to move during this timings Framework works best here.





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ICT 2022 Model

3. This model is fractal

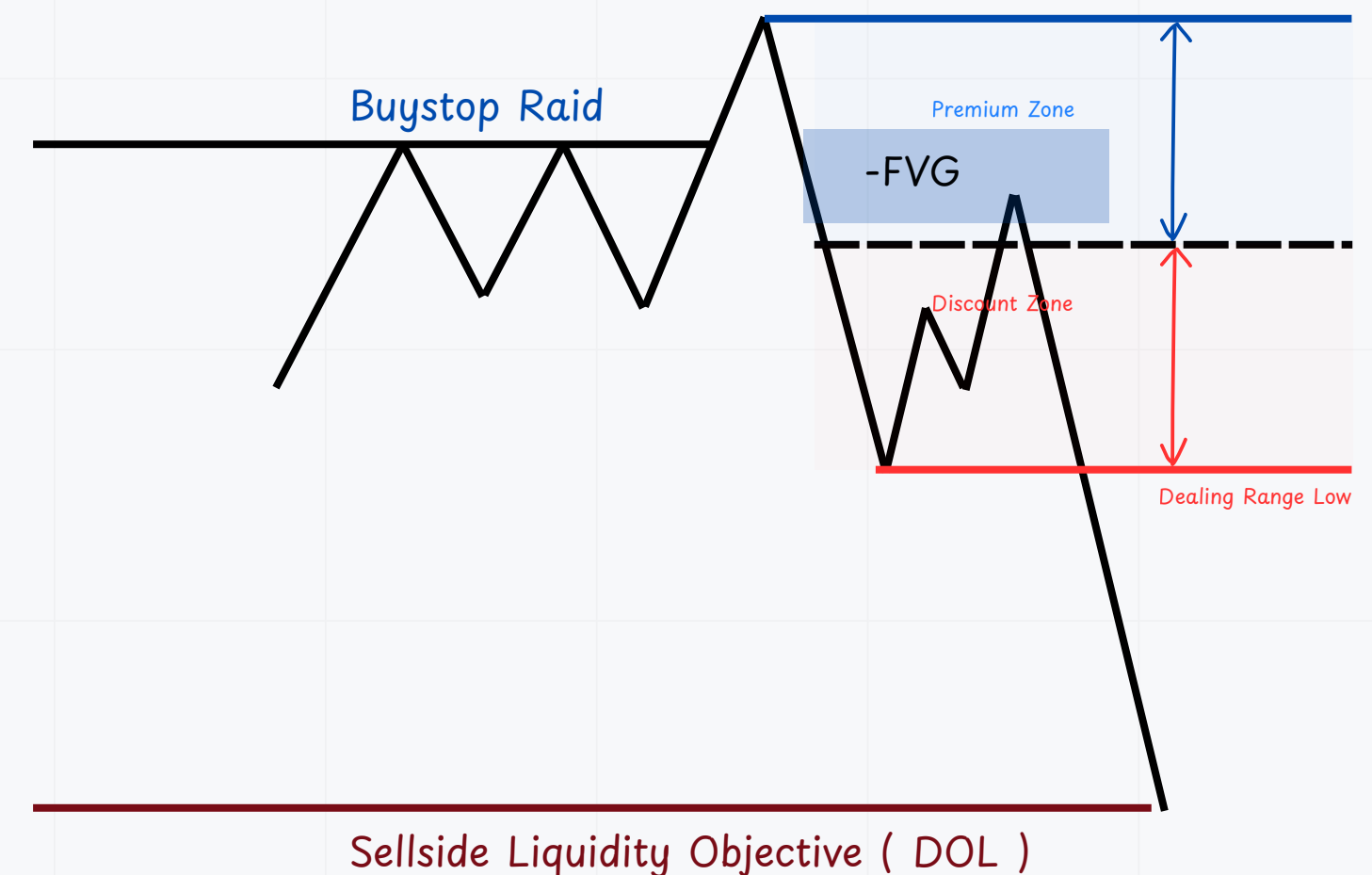
He repeats this many times :

- You can use this on 1m
- 5m
- 30m
- 1H
- 4H

Same logic.

Only time compression changes.
Liquidity → displacement → FVG → PD array.

Visual Representation



4. The setup logic (core mechanics)

Bearish model

You wait for:

1. Buy-side liquidity raid
 - Equal highs or a single high gets taken
2. Then a rapid drop
 - Breaks a recent 5m–1m low
 - (this is the M.S.S + displacement)

That displacement creates a Fair Value Gap

Ideal:

- FVG forms at or above equilibrium

Only then do you look to short.

Bullish model

You wait for:

1. Sell-side liquidity raid
 - Equal lows or a single low gets taken
2. Then a rapid rally
 - Breaks a recent 5m–1m high
3. That rally creates a Fair Value Gap

Ideal :

- FVG forms at or below equilibrium

Only then do you look to buy.

5. Entries / Targets

Bullish model

- For entry, place a buy limit at the FVG high, targeting the next Buyside Liquidity above.
- Stop goes below the swing low or the first candle of the FVG.

Bearish model

- For entry, place a sell limit at the FVG low, targeting the next Sellside Liquidity below.
- Stop goes above the swing high or the first candle of the FVG.

Summary :

After liquidity is taken, price displaces and forms a Fair Value Gap, then seeks opposing PD arrays at specific times of day.
That's it. Everything else is structure around that.





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ICT 2022 Model

(Chart Examples)

US 100 | | M5 | ICT 2022 Model Framework | Time Based Notes

US 100 Cash CFD · 5 · FOREX.com O25,415.7 H25,456.7 L25,409.7 C25,422.8

USD

1. Higher-timeframe order flow was bearish.

2. In bearish order flow, when price clears a buy-side liquidity pool, it often becomes a high-probability liquidity sweep

Buystop Raid

A.M Session

3. In this example, price cleared buy stops during the premarket session

F.V.G

F.V.G

4. Then delivered a shift in market structure, realigning with the bearish higher-timeframe order flow.

9:30 Open - 25,541.5

5. After the 9:30 open, price rebalanced the imbalances formed during the MSS.

6. From there, price delivered lower into sell-side liquidity within a relative discount area.

Sellside Liquidity

7. Later Price delivered even lower but the framework was completed here

Time Based Guide For Anticipating Trades

Where To Anticipate Trades:

AM Session-

At 8:30am EST News Embargo Lifting – When High Or Medium Impact News Is Released.
At 9:30am EST When US Equities Markets Open.
At 10:00am EST after first 30 minute Sentiment Is Established. [Judas Swing]
At 10:30am EST after first 60 minute Opening Range Is Established.
At 11:00am EST on Days Of The Week that offer conditions for market reversals. [Thursday or Friday]

PM Session-

At 1:30pm EST When New York Lunch Volume completes & volatility returns intraday.
At 2:00pm EST When PM trends start to unfold & potential AM Stops are purged.
At 2:30pm EST When the final two hours of trading begins.
At 3:00pm EST Final hour of day session trading ends for New York.
At 3:30pm EST Market On Close conditions begin.





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ICT 2022 Model

(Chart Examples)

US 100 | | M1 | ICT 2022 Model Framework





ICT Unicorn Model

What is ICT Unicorn Model ?

- The ICT Unicorn forms when a Fair Value Gap overlaps with a Breaker Block.
- This overlap creates a precise and reliable zone for identifying trade setup

Important Note ↓

- A clear HTF bias and narrative is essential for this model to function with consistency.

How to identify an ICT Unicorn ?

Identify

- Look for a break of a swing high or swing low.
- A Breaker Block should form at the point of the swing break.
- A Fair Value Gap must overlap with the Breaker Block.

Execution

- Wait for price to tap the FVG.
- Stop should be placed above Breaker & FVG high.
- Don't expect price to deliver FVG completely.
- The gaps which were formed below the Unicorn range should be left open as it will show the bullish intent & speed.

Targets

- Engineered Buyside liquidity in direction of our bias & draw.
- Use ICT standard deviations to get high probability target points.





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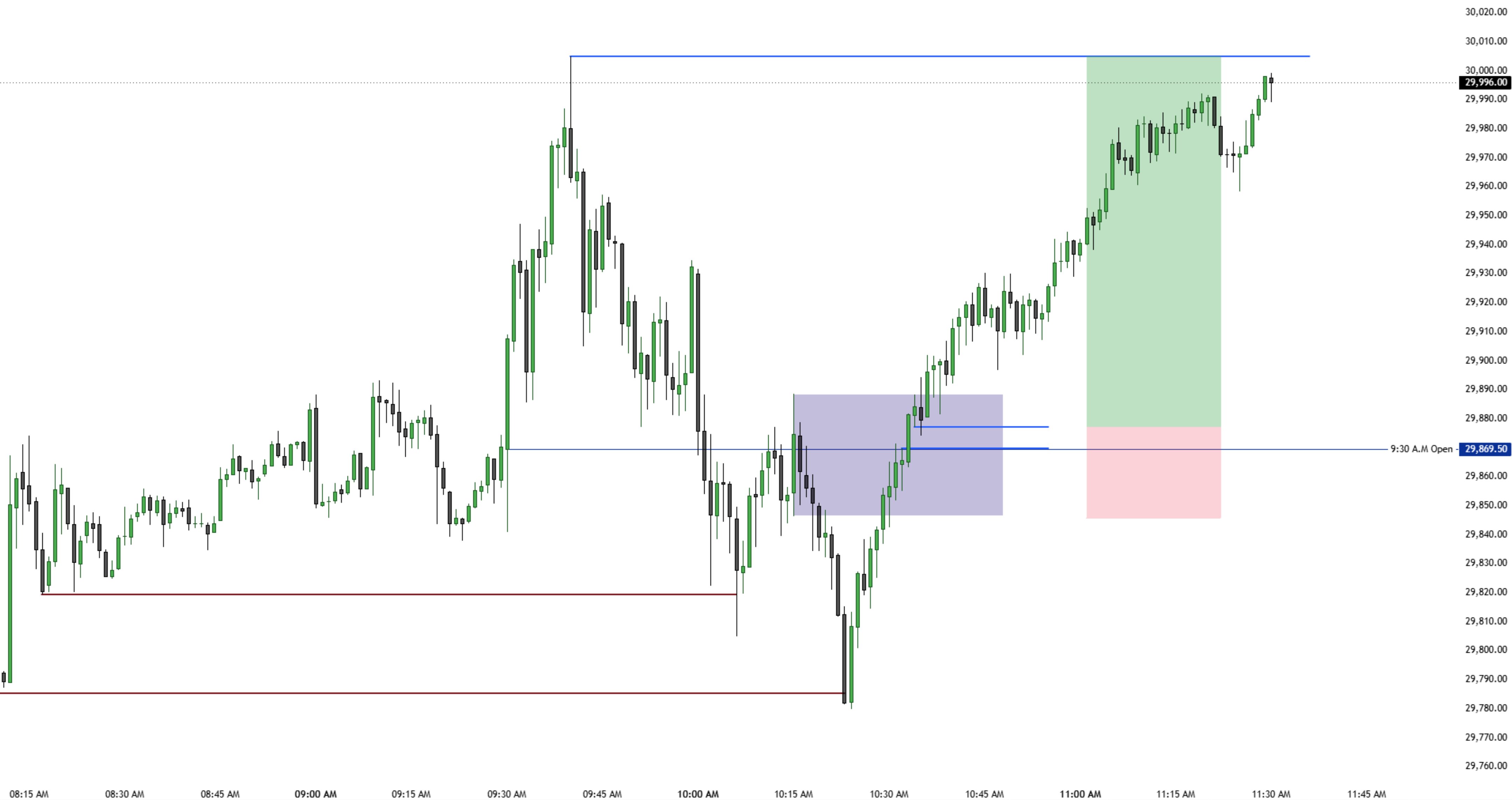
ICT Unicorn Model

(Chart Examples)

NASDAQ | M1 | Unicorn Entry Model Bullish Example

NASDAQ 100 E-mini Futures · 1 · CME O29,997.50 H29,999.25 L29,989.00 C29,996.00

USD





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ICT Unicorn Model

(Chart Examples)

1) The ICT Unicorn Model ?

- The ICT Unicorn forms when a Fair Value Gap overlaps with a Breaker Block.
- This overlap creates a precise and reliable zone for identifying trade setup

2) Identify an ICT Unicorn Model

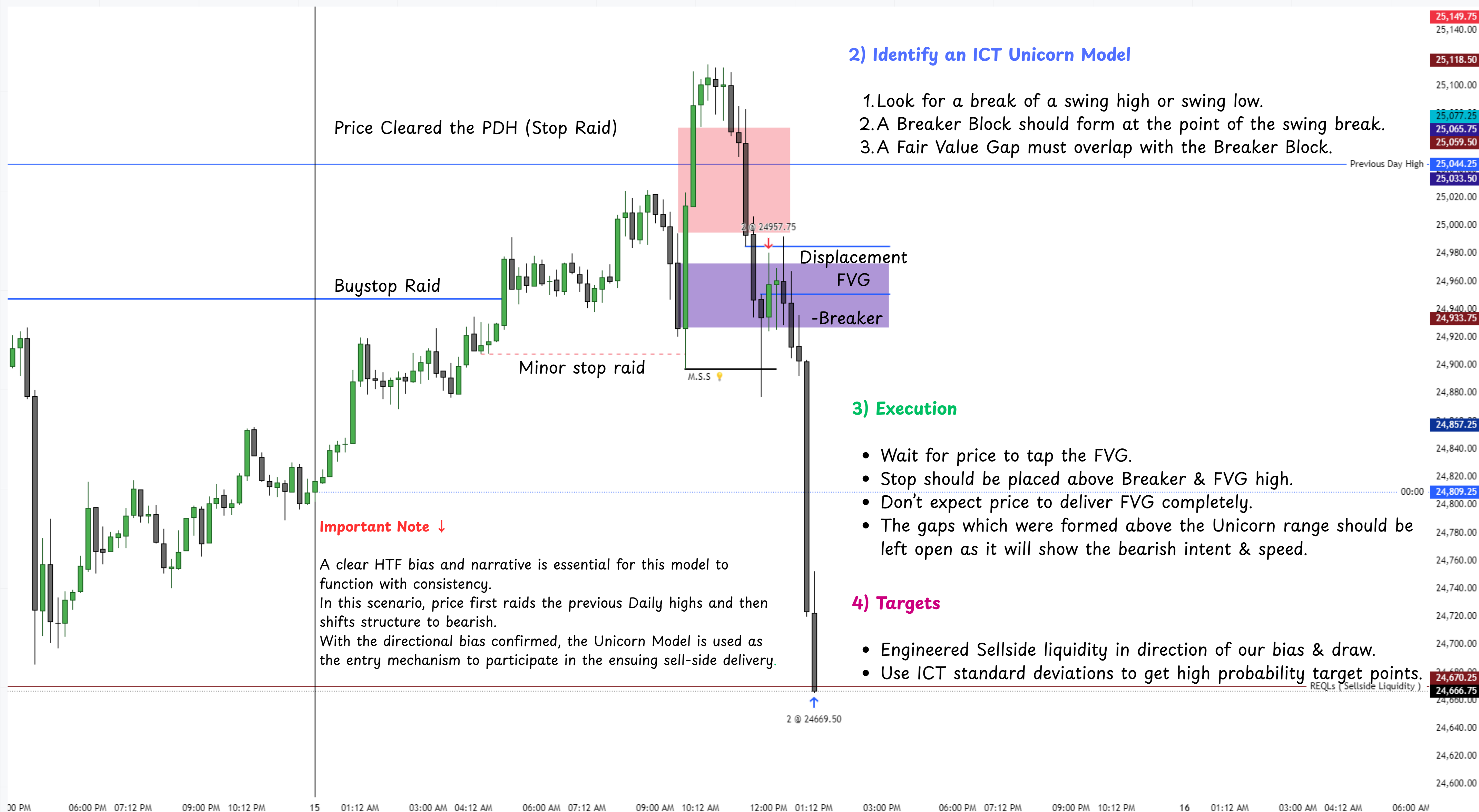
- 1.Look for a break of a swing high or swing low.
- 2.A Breaker Block should form at the point of the swing break.
- 3.A Fair Value Gap must overlap with the Breaker Block.

3) Execution

- Wait for price to tap the FVG.
- Stop should be placed above Breaker & FVG high.
- Don't expect price to deliver FVG completely.
- The gaps which were formed above the Unicorn range should be left open as it will show the bearish intent & speed.

4) Targets

- Engineered Sellside liquidity in direction of our bias & draw.
- Use ICT standard deviations to get high probability target points.



ICT INVERSION FVG Model

Core Logic Behind Inversion FVGs

An Inversion Fair Value Gap (IFVG) is a former Fair Value Gap that failed to hold price and was later violated by a decisive candle body close through the imbalance.

Once this happens, the Fair Value Gap flips its original directional expectation and begins acting as a new PD Array in the opposite direction.

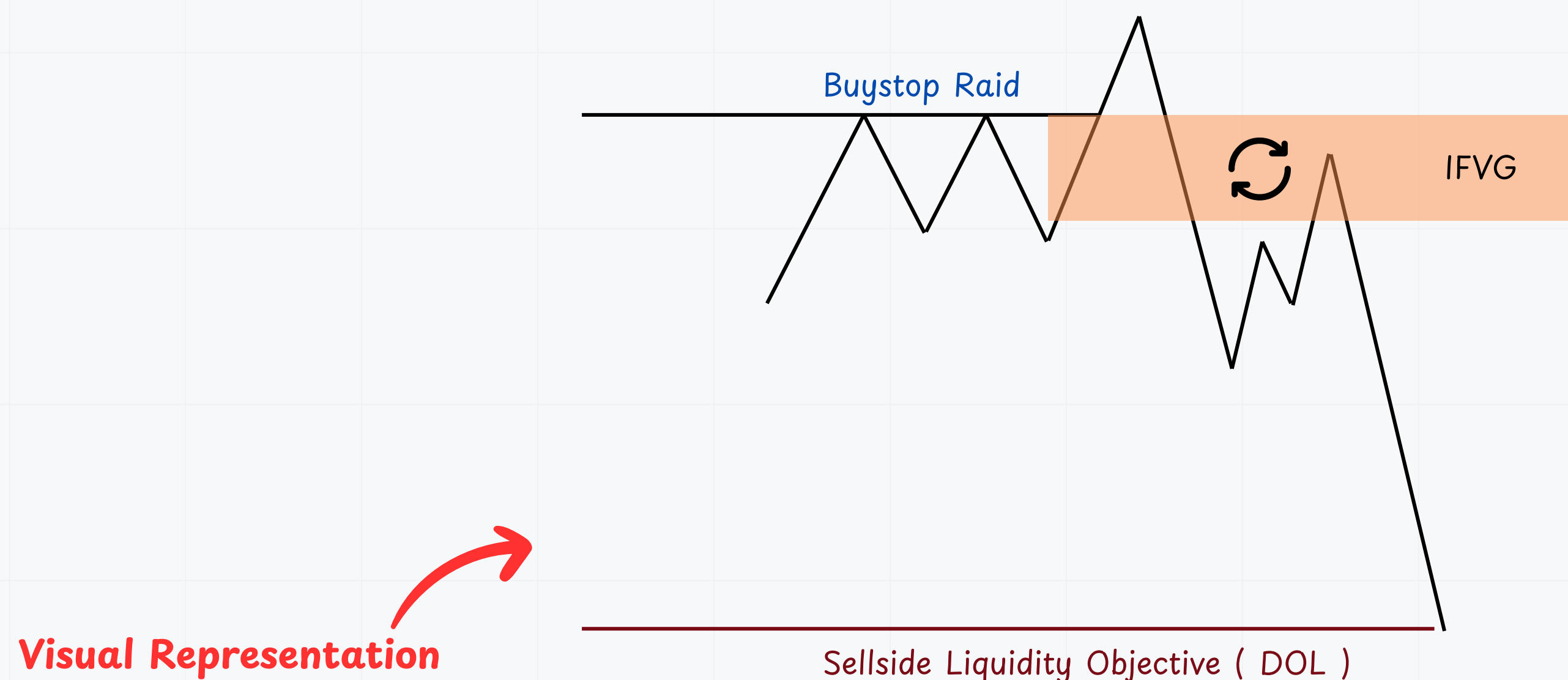
A bullish FVG that fails becomes bearish resistance.

A bearish FVG that fails becomes bullish support.

At its core, an IFVG represents: A Change In The State Of Delivery.

It signals that the algorithm has shifted from one side of the market to the other after:

- A Liquidity Sweep
- Displacement
- Failed Delivery



ICT INVERSION FVG Model

An IFVG is not just a pattern.

It represents:

Failed auction logic.

The side that originally controlled delivery loses control, trapped positions are created, and price reprices in the opposite direction.

An IFVG is not just a pattern.

It represents:

Failed auction logic.

The side that originally controlled delivery loses control, trapped positions are created, and price reprices in the opposite direction.

In simple terms 💡 :

- Fair Value Gap holds → continuation
- Fair Value Gap fails → inversion
- Inversion confirms delivery shift

This is why IFVGs are most effective when combined with:

- liquidity raids
- displacement
- HTF context
- premium/discount arrays
- market structure shifts



ICT INVERSION FVG Model

Types of Inversion Fair Value Gaps



Bullish Inversion FVG

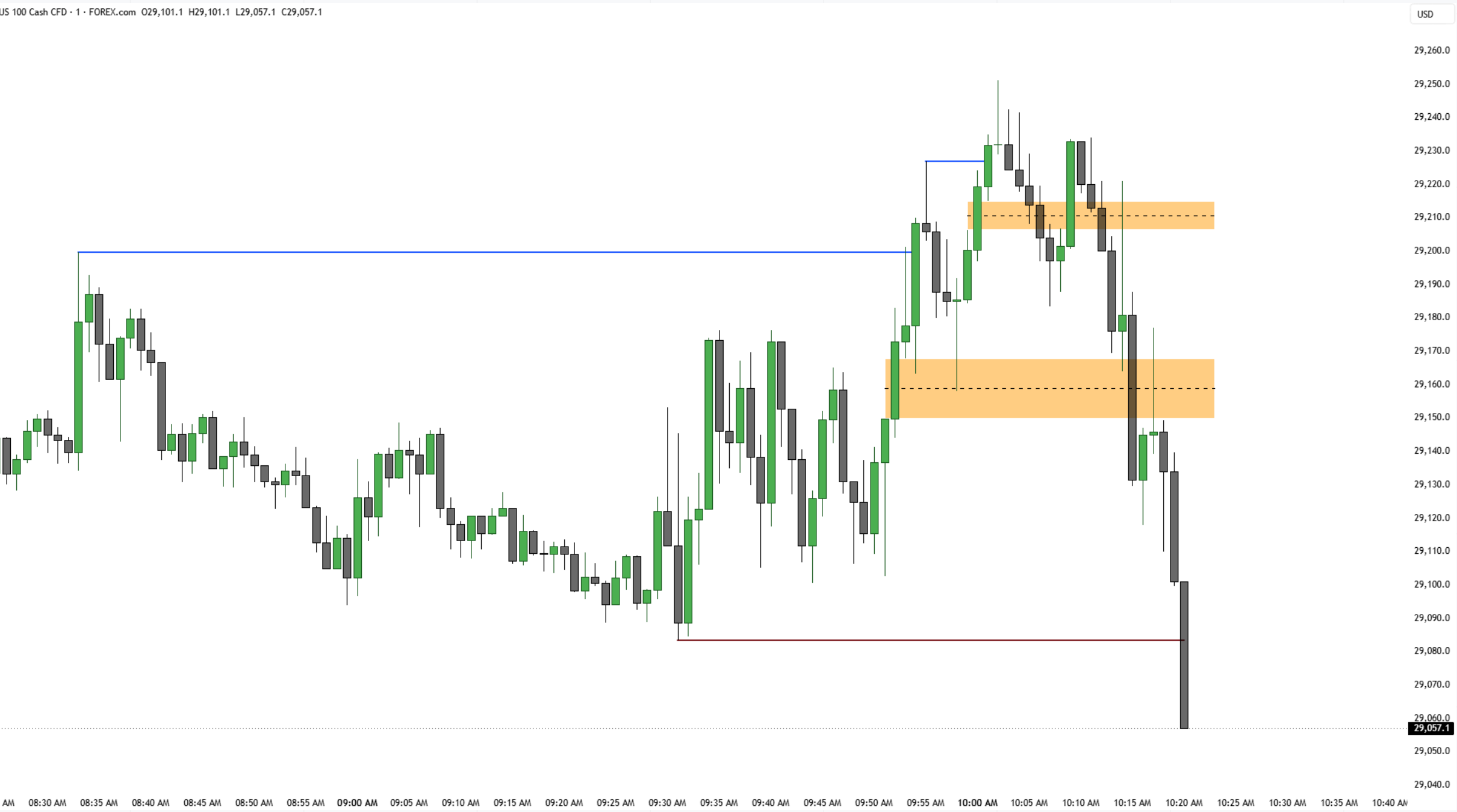
- Forms when a bearish FVG / SIBI fails to hold price.
- Confirmed by a strong candle body close above the gap.
- Signals a shift from a sell program into a buy program.
- The failed bearish imbalance flips into support.
- Price often retraces into the IFVG before continuing higher.

Confirmation:

- Once price closes above the FVG, we expect the zone to act as support.
- Respect from the IFVG suggests bullish continuation.
- Best formed after a liquidity sweep at discount.

What it means:

- Bearish delivery failed.
- The algorithm shifted into bullish delivery.
- The old bearish imbalance becomes a bullish PD Array.



Bearish Inversion FVG

- Forms when a bullish FVG / BISI fails to hold price.
- Confirmed by a strong candle body close below the gap.
- Signals a shift from a buy program into a sell program.
- The failed bullish imbalance flips into resistance.
- Price often retraces into the IFVG before continuing lower.

Confirmation:

- Once price closes below the FVG, we expect the zone to act as resistance.
- Respect from the IFVG suggests bearish continuation.
- Best formed after a liquidity sweep at premium.

What it means:

- Bullish delivery failed.
- The algorithm shifted into bearish delivery.
- The old bullish imbalance becomes a bearish PD Array.



ICT INVERSION FVG Model

How to identify High Probability IFVGs ?

For a Fair Value Gap to become an IFVG, the following must occur:

A Valid FVG Must Exist First

An imbalance formed by displacement :

- Three-candle structure
- Clear inefficiency (non-overlap condition)

Without a valid FVG → No IFVG is possible

Price Must Close THROUGH the Gap

Not wick. Not partial touch.

A candle body close must decisively trade beyond the gap boundary.

Example :

- Bullish FVG → Candle body closes below → Bearish IFVG
- Bearish FVG → Candle body closes above → Bullish IFVG

Why body close matters:

A wick = probe / liquidity interaction

A close = acceptance / repricing

IFVGs are not standalone entry signals. They work best when aligned with:

- Liquidity raid (stop hunt)
- Displacement / imbalance
- Higher timeframe narrative
- Correct time of day (killzones / macros)

Typical framework :

- Liquidity taken
- Displacement occurs
- FVG violated → IFVG created
- Look for retracement into IFVG
- Execute targeting opposing liquidity

Key Points Most Traders Miss

An IFVG represents a change already underway, not an anticipation model.

ICT INVERSION FVG Model

(Chart Examples)

US 100 | M5 | How to trade Inversion Fair Value Gaps ?



ICT INVERSION FVG Model

(Chart Examples)

US 100 | M5 | Bearish Chart Example



ICT 1st Presentation Model

How to identify 1st Presented FVG ?

This is the FVG formed inside the time based sessions taught by ICT

Example : 9:30 A.M - 10:00 A.M

There are a few characteristic the high probability 1st FVG should follow :

- **The FVG should formed after a liquidity raid .**
- **The FVG formation should create the displacement in price structure.**
- ICT says that these FVGs will be use across the IPDA data ranges especially 20 days range.

Core Idea Behind the Model



A simple, rule-based model

- Built around short-term bias and liquidity raids
- Focuses on algorithmic price delivery
- Waits for opposing liquidity to be taken
- Executes only at the 1st Presented FVG
- Enters where price is most efficient

ICT 1st Presentation Model

Step By Step Breakdown :

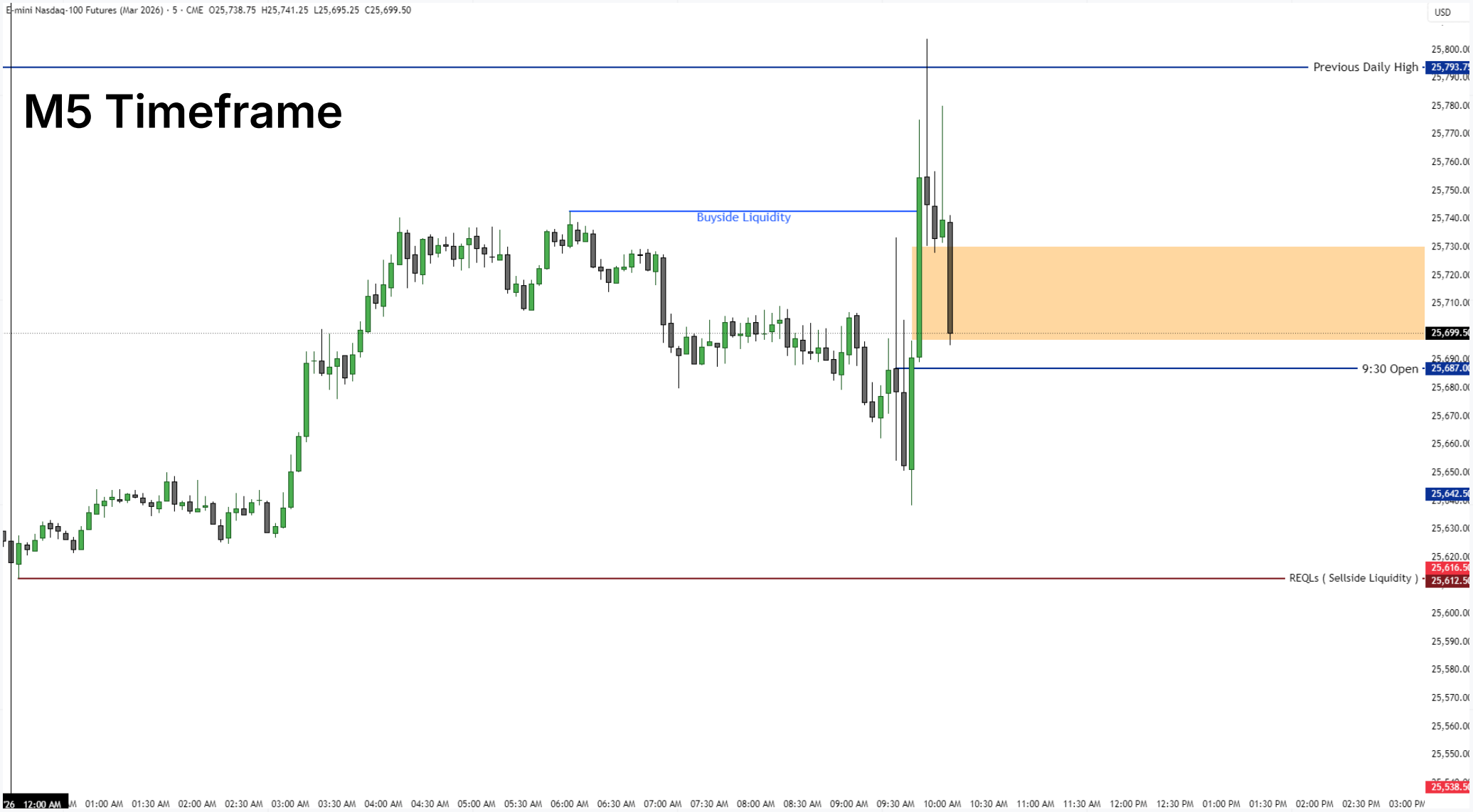
1.Start With Bias & Draw

Establish the Short term bias.

Identify the primary draw on liquidity (REH / REL / DOL levels).

In this example, the bias was Bearish, with Sellside liquidity resting below.

The Draw On Liquidity was : 25612

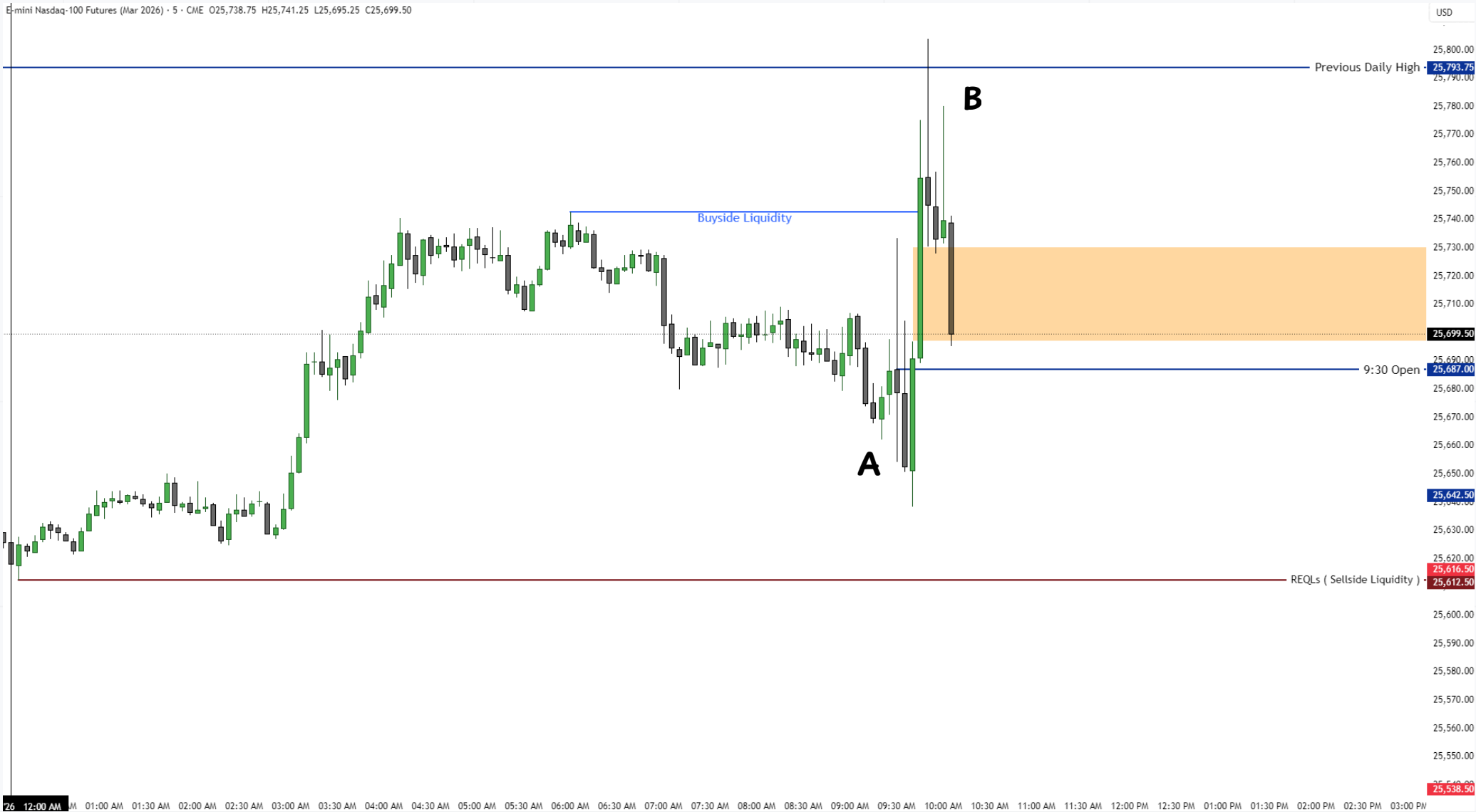


2.Wait for a Stop Raid

This move represents the Judas Swing designed to mislead and trap uninformed liquidity before the true price delivery begins

In this example, price cleared buyside liquidity and tapped a key level (PDH).

This price run (a - b) met the required conditions for valid model execution .

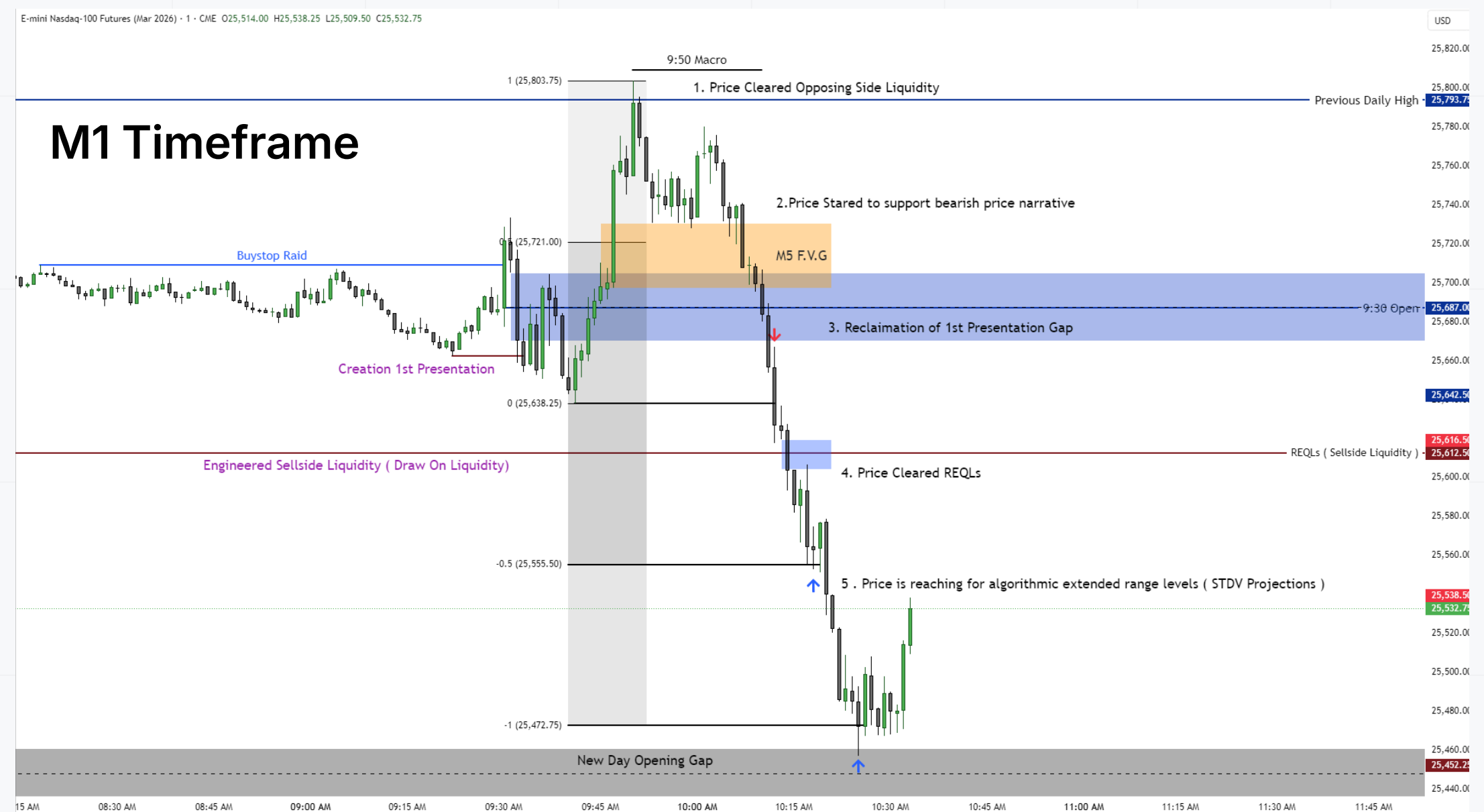


ICT 1st Presentation Model

Step By Step Breakdown :

3.The Model

The complete representation of the model



Important Points :

- The model Becomes even more high probabillity if the Draw On Liquidity aligns with Higher timeframe orderflow .
- The model works best in A.M session .
- Stop raid on opposing side liquidity is very essential.
- you can also use Co related SMT if Stop raid is not provided in the asset you are watching.
- Factor in time based Macro sessions for execution .

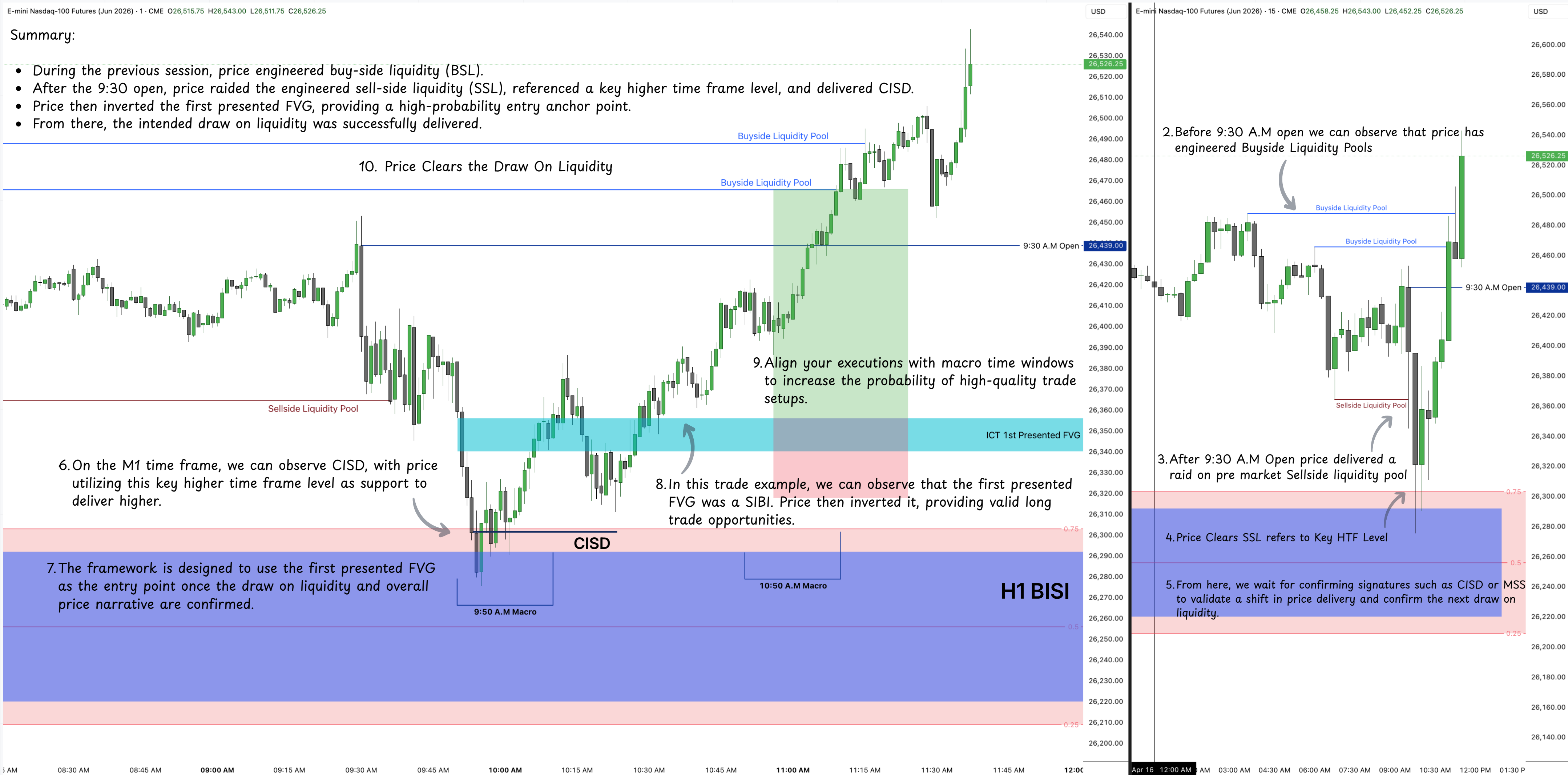
ICT 1st Presentation Model

NASDAQ | M1 | A.M Session | 1ST Presentation Model

E-mini Nasdaq-100 Futures (Jun 2026) · 1 · CME O26,515.75 H26,543.00 L26,511.75 C26,526.25

Summary:

- During the previous session, price engineered buy-side liquidity (BSL).
- After the 9:30 open, price raided the engineered sell-side liquidity (SSL), referenced a key higher time frame level, and delivered CISD.
- Price then inverted the first presented FVG, providing a high-probability entry anchor point.
- From there, the intended draw on liquidity was successfully delivered.



ICT 1st Presentation Model

NASDAQ | M1 | A.M Session | 1st Presentation Model

E-mini Nasdaq-100 Futures (Jun 2026) · 1 · CME O23,886.25 H23,946.00 L23,881.00 C23,945.50



ICT Optimal Trade Entry Model

Core Idea of OTE

Most traders think:

“OTE = 62–79% Fibonacci level → entry”

That’s wrong / incomplete.

What OTE actually is

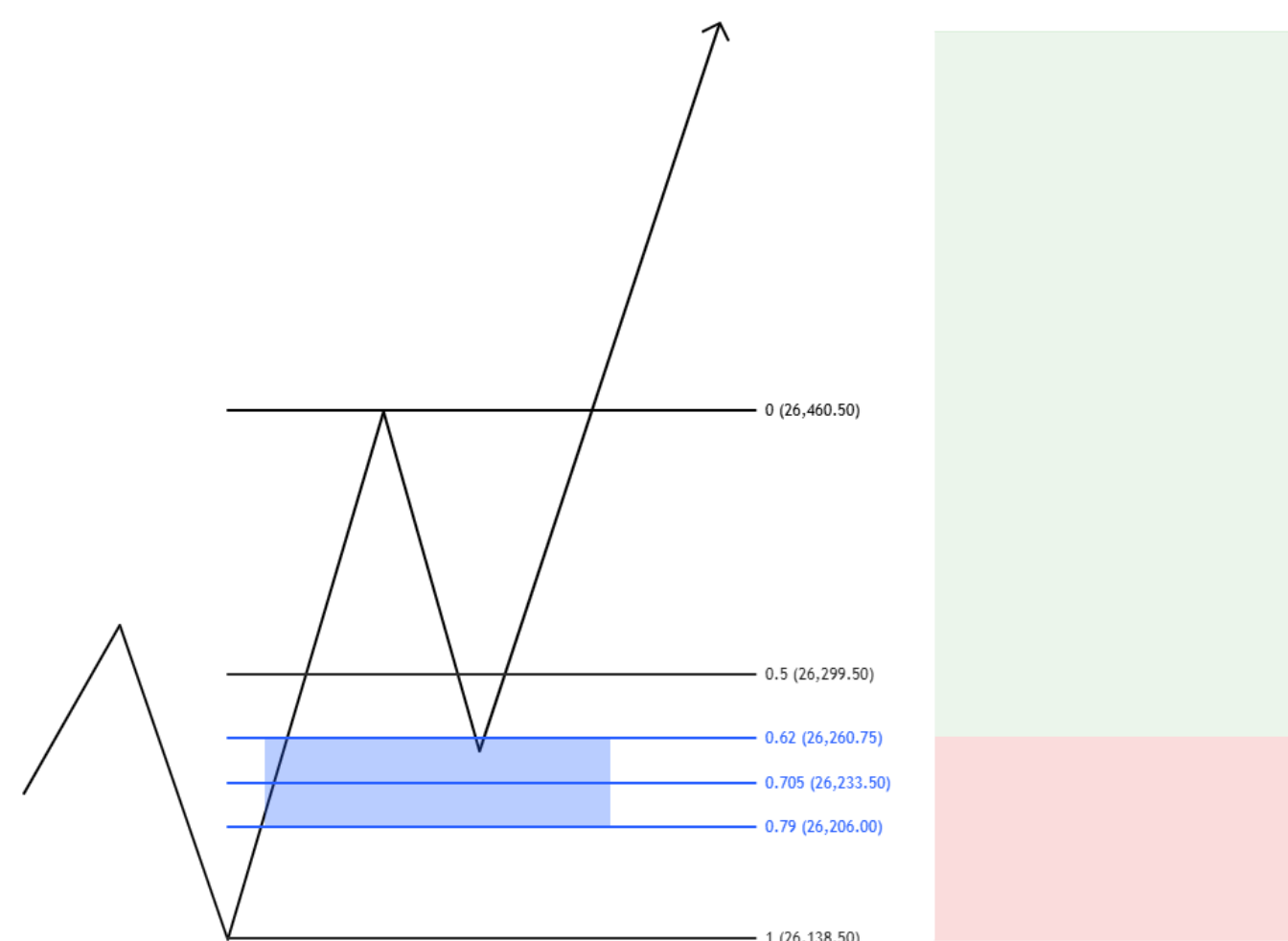
OTE = entering after liquidity is taken + displacement + retracement into inefficiency

Fibonacci is just a measurement tool, not the reason price reacts.

Logical Definition

The Optimal Trade Entry (OTE) model identifies high-probability entry zones within a retracement, typically between the 62%–79% Fibonacci levels, where price aligns with institutional order flow, liquidity objectives, and time-based delivery, offering precise execution opportunities within a defined narrative.

Schematic Representation of Optimal Trade Entry Model



ICT Optimal Trade Entry Model

Step By Step Breakdown :

1. Identify draw on liquidity
2. Watch for displacement (shift)
3. Wait for retracement (OTE zone)
4. Use FVG or OB in the range for entry
5. Enter with narrative
6. Target next liquidity

Breakdown of Optimal Trade Entry Model On Chart



ICT Optimal Trade Entry Model

Breakdown of Optimal Trade Entry Model On Chart

